INCH-POUND

A-A-55223
July 13, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FASTENER, PLASTIC, FOR EQUIPAGE ITEMS

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to MIL-F-43514.

Abstract. This Commercial Item Description covers the requirements for one type of plastic fastener for equipage items, such as ammunition pouches, tool carriers, and collapsible canteen covers. The fastener is intended only for attachment to materials having a compressed thickness of 0.010 inch minimum and 0.050 maximum.

Classification. The fastener is of one type and class.

Salient Characteristics. The fastener shall be composed of the following molded parts: latch, latch receptacle, locking clip for latch, and locking clip for latch receptacle. The design and dimensions of the fastener parts shall be in accordance with Figure 1.

The fastener's setting pinch shall be understood as clinch of the latch-clip assembly and the receptacle. The clinch of the latch and its clip and the receptacle and its clip shall each withstand a minimum pull of 120 pounds when tested as specified in the End Item Performance Testing section.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Clothing and Textiles Directorate, Attn: DPSC-FSSD, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101-8419, by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A

FSC 8465

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The color of the finished fastener shall be black. The fastener parts shall have a lusterless or dull finish on all surfaces, unless Figure 1 indicates otherwise. The finish shall be produced as a result of the molding operation and not by application of any protective coating, lacquer, or other materials.

Materials. All parts shall be made from acetal molding compound conforming to type I, class 2 of L-P-392 except that the electrical property requirements shall not apply. Clean, unburned plastic material in the form of imperfect parts, sprues, runners or other scraps of the same composition, produced in the molding or finishing operation, may be reground and mixed with the material. Recycled material may be used. The molding material may contain a surface lubricant.

Marking. The fastener shall be marked by an embossed molded-in process with manufacturers name or trademark, and the year of manufacture. The marking shall be located on any surface except those surfaces which are outermost when the fastener is in use. The letter size shall be approximately 3/32 inch in height, and the characters shall be raised approximately 0.007 inch.

Workmanship. The parts shall be clean, smooth, and free from cracks, dirt, flash, and surface defects such as splay and jetting marks. All gates shall be trimmed flush with the molding surface. The posts on the latch and latch receptacle shall be fully formed and free from any imperfection, which may interfere with their locking engagement, when assembled to the locking clips.

Product Demonstration Model. When required, offerers shall submit samples of their intended production. The Product Demonstration Model will consist of units independently developed. Product Demonstration Models will be analyzed and evaluated by the government. Evaluation criteria and basis for award are contained in the solicitation. Product Demonstration Models will be retained by the government. One (1) Product Demonstration Model approved by DPSC under the resultant contract will serve as a manufacturing standard for the corresponding production items delivered under this contract. Offerers are advised that the Product Demonstration Model does not relieve the successful offerer of his responsibility to perform in accordance with the Commercial Item Description specified above.

Quality Assurance

Certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

otherwise provided for, under the provisions of the contract. Reliance on contractor QA systems shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract.

Examination. Fastener lots shall be inspected in accordance with "Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes", ANSI/ASQC Z1.4, published by the American Society for Quality Control.

Visual Examination. The fasteners shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of fastener. The sample unit is one fastener. The inspection level shall be I, and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

Defects. The fasteners shall be examined for the following defects:

Design/Construction	Fastener assembly not in compliance with Figure 1; any part broken, cracked, chipped, distorted, twisted, or malformed; any dirt or flash; any deep scratch or gouge; gates not trimmed as specified; unsmoothed surface; any pit, void, crazing, air pocket, blister, or imbedded foreign matter affecting serviceability; evidence of splay or jetting marks; latch/receptacle mating failure
Color and finish	Wrong color, unspecified finish, evidence of coating; density or appearance of material not uniform
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, or method of application

Dimensional Examination. The finished dimensions shall conform to Figure 1. Any dimension that is not within the established tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The sample unit shall be one fastener; the inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

Packaging Examination. The fully packaged shipping containers shall be examined in accordance with defects listed below. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.0.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

EXAMINE	DEFECT
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, improper taping, or inadequate stapling
Content	Number of items in container is more or less than required
	NSN shown on one or more items not as specified on shipping container
Palletization	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirements
	Pallet type not as specified
	Load not bonded as specified

Regulatory Requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

End Item Performance Testing. The fastener shall be tested for strength of the clinch in accordance with the procedure below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one complete fastener. The sample unit for this test shall be one complete fastener. The inspection level shall be S-2, and the lot shall be unacceptable if any sample unit fails to meet the requirements specified below. All test reports shall contain the individual values utilized in expressing the final result.

Test specimens shall be conditioned at $73.5^{\circ} \pm 2^{\circ}F$ and 50 percent $\pm$ 4 percent relative humidity for 24 hours prior to the test, and the test shall be performed under these conditions.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Assemble the latch receptacle and its locking clip with two pieces of brass strip (0.010 inch thick) stock, as shown in figure 1. The brass strips shall be pre-punched before assembling. Clinch the posts of the latch receptacle by hot or cold heading by the same method to be used in the manufacture of the equipage items on which the fastener will be attached. The top of the clinched posts shall be below the surface of the locking clip. The specimen for testing the clinch of the latch shall be prepared in the same manner as that for the latch receptacle except that the latch shall be cut off one inch from the top and the top part (including the posts) of the latch shall be used in the test. The "setting pinch," after heading, for the latch with latch locking clip and the latch receptacle with latch receptacle locking clip under this test shall be 0.310 $\pm$ 0.004 inch and 0.625 $\pm$ 0.004 inch, respectively. The "setting pinch" is the measurement at which fastener units are correctly attached, and is obtained by adding the compressed thickness of any given foundation (in this case, brass strips) to the "basic pinch." The "basic pinch" of a fastener unit (latch with latch locking clip or latch receptacle with latch receptacle locking clip) is the measurement, made by micrometer, from the exposed surface of the latch or latch receptacle to over the rolled ends of the posts as these parts are brought into contact with their locking clips in the normally applied relationship. The "basic pinch" for the latch with locking clip and the latch receptacle with locking clip is 0.290 inch and 0.605 inch, respectively. The die that clinches the posts shall be a double tested rolling die, common to both the latch and latch receptacle. With the test assembly in a horizontal position, bend the two ends of one of the brass strips upward so that they touch and clamp these ends together in the upper clamp of a tensile testing machine. Bend the two ends of the other brass strip downward so that they touch and clamp these ends in the lower clamp of the tensile tester. The distance between the jaws at the beginning of the test shall be four inches and the rate of jaw separation shall be twelve inches per minute. Report to the nearest pound the force indicated on the machine at the time of rupture of the assembly. Any specimen rupturing (completely separating) at a force below 120 pounds shall be considered to have failed the test.

Certificates of Conformance. Certificates of Conformance shall be provided to government Quality Assurance Representative, when this component is designated in a government procured end item.

Preservation, Packing, and Marking. The preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source of Government Documents. Copies of Military and Federal documents are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Bldg. 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

Sources of Nongovernment Documents.

ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables For Inspection By Attributes

(Applications for copies should be addressed to American National Standards Institute, 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018-3308.)

Custodian:
Army - GL
Navy - NU

Review Activity:
Navy - MC

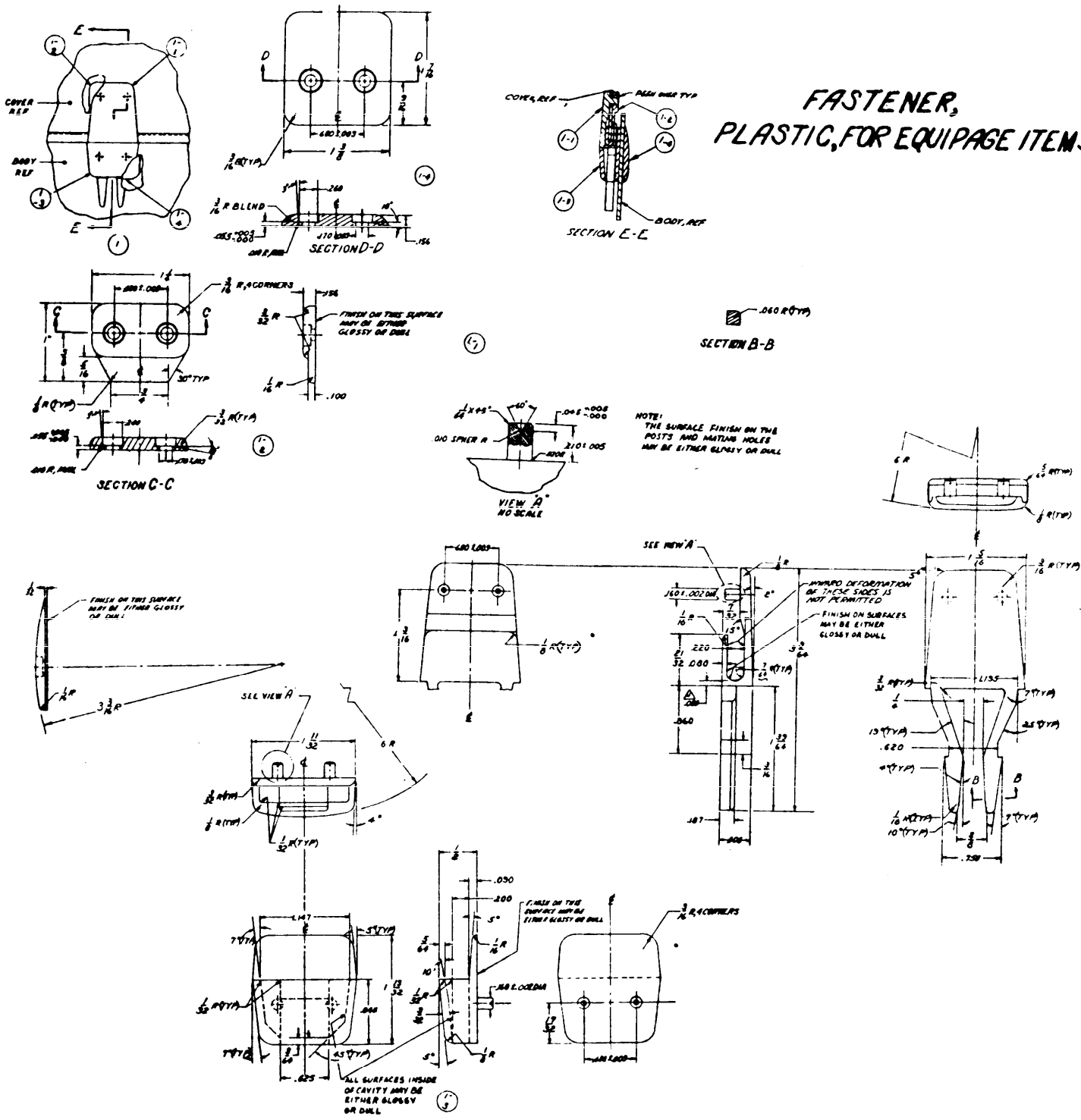
Civil Agency Coordinating Activity:
GSA - FSS

Preparing Activity:
DLA - CT

Project No. 8465-0155

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FASTENER, PLASTIC, FOR EQUIPAGE ITEMS



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	A-A-55223	13 JULY 1993

3. DOCUMENT TITLE

FASTENER, PLASTIC, FOR EQUIPAGE ITEMS

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code)	
Defense Personnel Support Center ATTN: DPSC-FSSD (12-3-D)	(1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) 2800 South 20th Street P. O. Box 8419 Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

DD Form 1426, OCT 89 *Previous editions are obsolete.* 198/290

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CONSTRUCTION Any required detail of construction